

LEAGUE OF
UNITED LATIN AMERICAN CITIZENS
COUNCIL NO. 132
EL PASO, TEXAS



"All for One,
One for All"

September 29, 1949.

PRES. HENRY MARTINEZ
VICE-PRES. FRANCISCO HERNANDEZ
SEC. ROBERT DOMINGUEZ
TREAS. ENRIQUE PARRA

Dr. George I. Sanchez,
% The University of Texas,
Austin, Texas.

Dear Dr. Sanchez:

I offer my apologies for not replying sooner to your kind letter of September 20th. I thought it would be better to give some serious thought to the matter before answering it, so that I could present a clearer picture of the problems we face here in El Paso.

We are sorry that you could not visit El Paso on your return from Nevada, because we would have liked to meet with you and discuss our problems with you.

I note that you say that there is a chance of your coming out here some time in the next two or three months. Much as we would like to have you, I am forced to tell you - so that you will not labor under a false impression - that we have no funds with which to finance a trip. I write this regretfully, but I think you understand that all the work we do is on a voluntary basis. There is not too much money available, and so many places in which to spend it. It's just too bad that money doesn't grow with the crusading spirit, because our organization would really be relieved of financial embarrassment.

Our immediate problems seem to bail down to these:

1. In the nearby town of Whitespur, the school bus will not pick up children of Mexican descent.
2. In El Paso, children attending the northside school are given fifteen minutes' conversational Spanish, while those attending the southside schools are not.
3. The school system of El Paso has four schools that do not have lunchrooms. Three of these schools are located on the southside.
4. One of the truant officers has, of late, been "fining" the parents of school-age children who do not attend school. This results in a belief by the parents that if they pay the fine, it is satisfactory for the children to miss school and seek gainful employment, even though they are not of age.
5. The Anglo residents of public housing project in Tays Place send their children to the northside schools instead of to Beall School - the school in the locality, which they are supposed to attend.

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We cannot hope to eliminate all these instances of discrimination overnight, but if we could work constructively towards that end, we feel that a great stride will have been made. What one to tackle first as a stepping stone towards the accomplishment of the others needs much thought, because if we antagonize a group in the beginning, we will delay any forward action for some time to come. How to tackle it comes next - and this probably is more important than the "What" - and here again we face the problem of peoples' prejudices.

Will you analyze our problems and help us in our approach to their solution? I can assure you that we shall be very grateful for any assistance that you can give us.

I do hope that we shall have an opportunity to meet you and discuss these matters with you.

Many thanks for your kind offer of help.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Luciano Santhoscoy". The signature is written in dark ink and is positioned below the word "Sincerely,". It features a long, horizontal flourish extending to the right.

LS:hkh

P.S.

We now have a list of all the residents at Days Place, and are checking where they are employed (the Anglos)